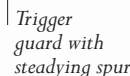


After the Colt percussion-cap revolvers, the next major breakthrough in pistol design was the Smith & Wesson Model 1, produced in 1857. Horace Smith and Daniel Wesson had purchased a patent from gunsmith Rollin White for a revolver in which the chambers were bored through the full length of the cylinder, which made breech-loading possible. This design was combined with their .22in rim-fire brass cartridge to enable fast reloading, which transformed the use of handguns. Smith & Wesson won important international orders for their No. 3 Model in 1871, by which time more powerful centre-fire cartridges were replacing the earlier rim-fire ones.



Date 1853

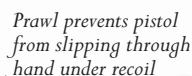
Origin France

Weight 950g (33½oz)

Barrel 13.5cm (5¼in)

Calibre 12mm Pin-fire

French gunsmith Casimir Lefaucheur invented the pin-fire cartridge in the mid-1830s, and his son Eugène later produced a six-shot, double-action revolver for it in 12mm calibre. This is a cavalry model.



◀ SMITH & WESSON NO. 3
RUSSIAN MODEL

Date 1871

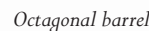
Origin US

Weight 1.25kg (2¾lb)

Barrel 20.3cm (8in)

Calibre .44in S&W Russian

Smith & Wesson won a contract to supply the Russian Army with 20,000 of their No. 3 pistol, chambered for a special cartridge. These were the most accurate revolvers of the day.



— *Fore sight*

▲ DUTCH M1873 ARMY REVOLVER

Date 1873

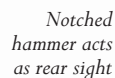
Origin Netherlands

Weight 1.04kg (2¼lb)

Barrel 16cm (6¼in)

Calibre 9.4 × 21mm Rim-fire

Two models of the M1873 were made for the Dutch Army. The earlier model had an octagonal barrel, while the later one had a round barrel.



Barrel screws
into frame

◀ COLT SINGLE-ACTION ARMY MODEL 1873

Date 1873

Origin US

Weight 1.1kg (2½lb)

Barrel 19cm (7½in)

Calibre .45in

The Colt SAA ("Peacemaker") married the single-action lock of the old Dragoon model to a bored-through cylinder in a solid frame, into which the barrel was screwed.



▲ REMINGTON ARMY MODEL 1875

Date 1875

Origin US

Weight 1.1kg (2½lb)

Barrel 19cm (7½in)

Calibre .45in

The single-action Model 1875 was the same size and had the same removable cylinder as the Model 1858. The gun was also adapted for .40in and .44in cartridges.